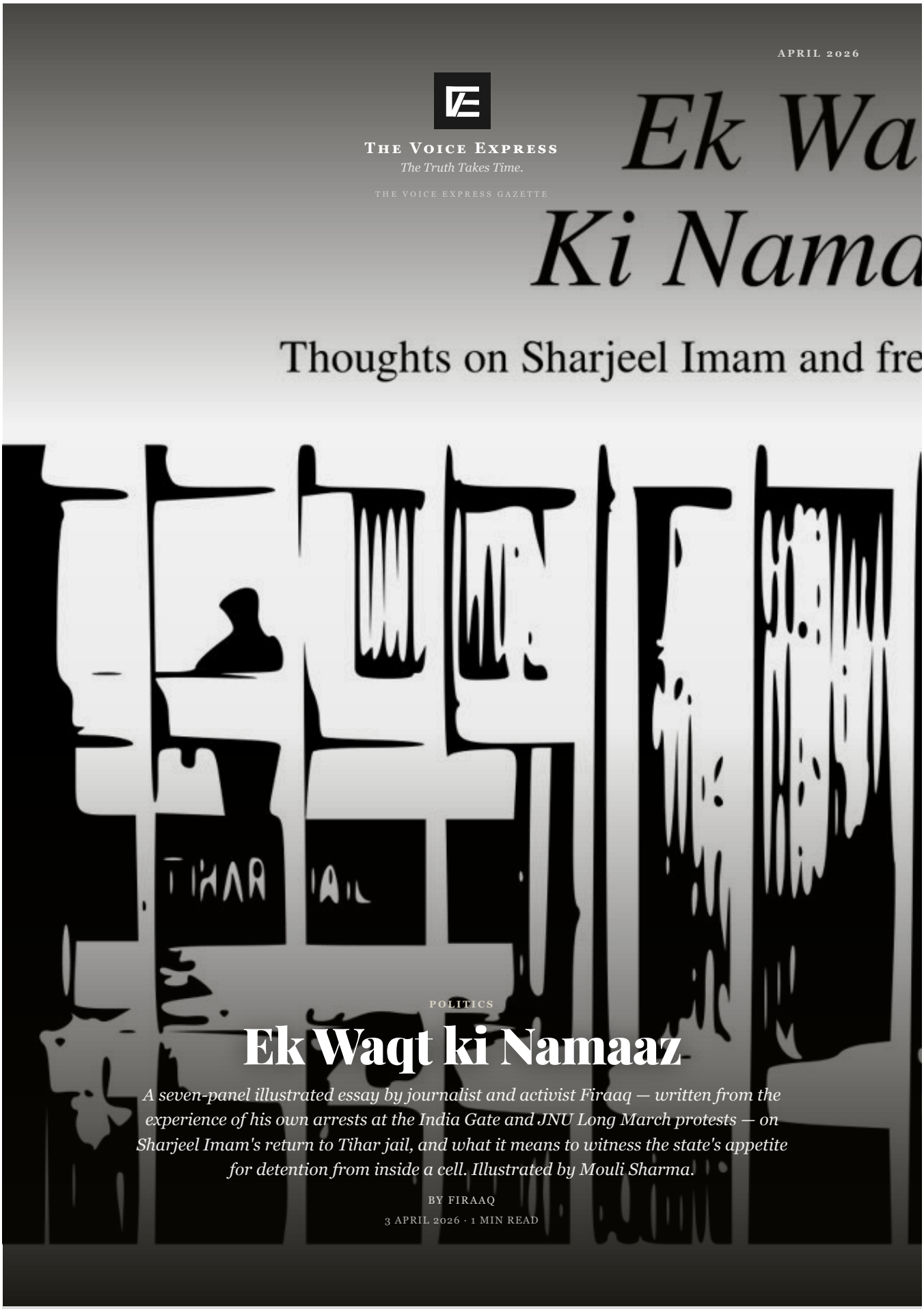
APRIL 2026

THE VOICE EXPRESS
The Truth Takes Time.

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POLITICS

Ek Waqt ki Namaaz

A seven-panel illustrated essay by journalist and activist Firaaq — written from the experience of his own arrests at the India Gate and JNU Long March protests — on Sharjeel Imam's return to Tihar jail, and what it means to witness the state's appetite for detention from inside a cell. Illustrated by Mouli Sharma.

BY FIRAAQ

3 APRIL 2026 · 1 MIN READ

The Voice Express

The Truth Takes Time.

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Thoughts on Sharjeel Imam and Freedom

Following is a seven panel series illustrating the author, Firaaq's thoughts on Sharjeel's return to Tihar, formed from his own experiences in jail (Firaaq was first arrested last year in November during the India Gate protests as a journalist and independent participant, and again this year at the JNU Long March protest in February, again, as a journalist and independent participant). It has been edited and illustrated by Mouli Sharma.

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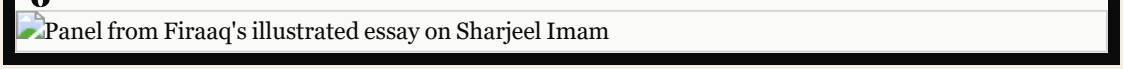
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Firaaq is a scholar of human rights and an independent journalist based in New Delhi. His work has appeared in publications like NewClick[1], GroundXero[2], and Nutan Charcha.

> *Mouli Sharma[3] is an independent journalist and illustrator from New Delhi. Her work has appeared in publications like Maktoob Media[4], GroundXero[5], The Observer Post[6], The Leaflet[7],Nivarana[8],The Polis Project[9],Article 14[10],Feminism in India[11], and been republished in SabrangIndia[12], NewsClick[13] andThink Global Health[14]. She is a published photojournalist & illustrator and has been featured in theHindu College Gazette[15] and the quarterly Pink Disco[16]. She is the editor-in-chief of the student-run news site, The Voice Express[17], and is a literary editor for the digital lit-mag, The Queer Gaze[18].*

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Firaaq is a scholar of human rights and an independent journalist based in New Delhi. His work has appeared in publications likeNewClick,GroundXero, and Nutan Charcha.

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